

DESIREE HOWELL

UI Programming · C++ · Game & Front-End Interfaces

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Computer Science student at NC State in the Game Development concentration, seeking a Summer 2027 UI Programmer internship at Epic Games. Pairs C++ game-engine coursework and Unity and UEFN game projects with a decade of building and shipping user-facing interfaces, from React front ends to a small business's public website, plus two years of professional software work at Infosys.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	C++, C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C, SQL, HTML/CSS
Game & Engine	Unreal Editor for Fortnite (UEFN), Unity, custom C++ engine architecture, input systems, gameplay programming, level design
UI & Front End	React, TypeScript, Tailwind, component-based UI, responsive layout, client-side routing, data-driven views
Back End	Node.js, Express, MongoDB/Mongoose, MySQL, REST APIs, Socket.io
Tools	Git/GitHub, Vite, Firebase, Heroku, npm, VS Code, command line

PROJECTS

Custom Game Engine · C++: Team-built 2D engine for NC State's engine architecture course. Implemented the input handling system that maps raw device events to the actions gameplay code consumes, the layer every player-facing interaction runs through.

Would You Still Love Me? · Unity, C#: Narrative relationship simulator. Sole programmer on the project team: implemented every gameplay system and the branching dialogue logic that drives what the player sees and chooses. Published on itch.io.

Bee The Change · UEFN: Level designer on a game jam entry built in Unreal Editor for Fortnite: blocked out, playtested, and iterated the level layout and pacing. Winner, Best Use of UEFN Tools, UNCG Games for a Change Jam.

Cloverleaf · React, Express, MongoDB, Socket.io: Full-stack forum with real-time chat, built by a team of four. Designed the UI and implemented core features, including Socket.io messaging and Passport authentication.

Portfolio Site · React, TypeScript, Tailwind: Ground-up rebuild of a 2019 Create React App portfolio on a modern Vite toolchain, written by hand rather than migrated: client-side routing, responsive layout, and project data driven from JSON.

EXPERIENCE

Technical Associate, Extended Learning Program · Infosys, Raleigh, NC 2021 – 2023

- Wrote and maintained web application code in JavaScript and Java on contract engagements, working to enterprise delivery standards and deadlines.
- Completed a two-year technical development program and earned internal certifications in Java and full-stack web development.
- Presented project work to managers and peer engineers on a recurring cadence, defending technical decisions in review.

Web Administrator · Angelhare Forest Tree Farm, Raleigh, NC 2013 – Present

- Sole designer and developer of the public website for a family business operating in the Triangle since 1986, owning the user-facing experience end to end for over a decade.
- Ship seasonal site updates and marketing content ahead of each peak season, supporting a repeat-customer base of 100+ annual visitors.

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University, B.S. Computer Science, Game Development Concentration Expected May 2028

- Relevant coursework: Game Engine Architecture (C++), Data Structures, Operating Systems, Game Design.
- Webmaster, Video Game Development Club: sole owner of the club's website: UI design, build, content, and semester-to-semester maintenance.
- Prior coursework: Wake Technical Community College (CS transfer credit); Meredith College (CS major coursework).

UNC-Chapel Hill Coding Bootcamp, Full-Stack Web Development Certificate

- Built and deployed full-stack applications end to end: React front ends, Express and Node.js APIs, and MySQL and MongoDB data layers.

HONORS & AWARDS

- Best Use of UEFN Tools** — UNCG Games for a Change Game Jam, 2026.
- First Place, DiamondHacks Hackathon** — Meredith College, team of four, 2014.